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Have you ever wanted to see, control, and live through the building of human history, from the first firepit to the development of complex, interwoven cultures and empires? That kind of simulation, with just the right amount of simplification so things are comprehensible, manageable, and not overwhelming, is exactly what Sticks and Stones delivers.

You start with a close-knit tribe of six humans in the paleolithic era, or 'old stone age'. You quickly discover the function of ROLES, which group determined tasks that create new products out of existing resources, or perform essential services for your tribe. Each of your tribe members have roles like 'Knapper', 'Carver', and 'Hunter'– all Producer Roles which can create new items from simpler items. You'll also discover that each tribe member can achieve multiple roles at a cost. And you'll need them, too, as its not easy to necessarily easy to make anything out of what nature provides.

Soon enough, as your tribe grows beyond its initial limits, its members will start to grow antsy to go beyond their current potential and conditions. If you manage to develop an excess of resources against the harsh world, you'll be able to support wisened 'Elders' who will be able to train the new generations, and 'Scouts', who can explore to new lands and meet new peoples with new traditions: both of who can push you into further ages.

It isn't long until the overflowing drive of life drives artistic expression: 'Storytellers' collect the tribes' tales of strife and triumph, and 'Ornamenters' turn the previously useless waste from your hunting expeditions into the first jewelry, and with it you witness the power of keeping people together through Culture.

On the less pretty side, you'll also need to defend your tribe against those who are also developing at a rapid pace, especially after 'Farmer's and 'Herder's hail the turn of the agricultural revolution– 'Slingers' and 'Skirmishers' able to utilize ordinary, abundant sticks and stones to defend your tribe, and eventually 'Shortbow Hunters' are able to take down both animals and invaders before they even approach. It's a tough world out there, and you need Force to defend yourself.

If you're able to survive the harsh changes of the Neolithic era, whether by the flattery and dealmaking of the 'Negotiator' or the strength of your

warriors, a new world of civilization is waiting on the other side: first, the discovery of useful metals by the 'Copper Miner' and 'Coppersmith' allow for the construction of better tools and herald an arms race for ages to come.

But with the rise of such productive industry and flourshing culture comes the problem of the distribution of its spoils. For their Satisfaction, some will demand more goods than others, while some may be tempered by the wiles of the 'Prostitute'– or the 'Priest'.

As we dig deeper, sail further, burn hotter fires, and spin prettier artworks, the invention and reinvention of new Roles proliferates throughout society– and with them, a better grasp of how to continue to push forward in this complex world. Everything falls apart without the maintainence of different kinds of Order– Culture, Force, and Satisfaction, and in the emerging world, Legal and Administrative. And nothing can be retained and push forward without a vast array of Knowledge– Exploration of the natural world and its features, ingenious Academic theories, the Technological prowess to change the conditions of the world, the Roles needed to do so, and lastly how those that are Foreign differ– and our similar– to ourselves. All of these will have to be managed in some way, decided by your history, and the classes formed by it. Will it be anarchy? Or a massive layer of 'Bureaucrat's? A complex network of competing 'Lawyer's and 'Senators'? Or one 'King' who's word is law?

No matter what happens, politics and culture, both within and without, explode in complexity. And that's not just for your people as individuals, but for them as a 'people'– will you join with another peaceful tribe? Or be forced into subjugation by a larger horde? Years later, will your people see themselves as part of the conquerors, or still be secretly fighting for independence? Who you are, where you are, and what your interests are are pushed by forces which in turn are pushed by other forces, not always obvious at first glance– your people's perception of the neighboring kingdom determines whether they'll perceive cheese as luxurious or commonplace. How long they've settled in an area determines whether they hunger for foreign imports, or are distrustful of anything arriving by sea.

With over 250 roles from the Paleolithic to the Medieval age, in a Tile-based game with regions, plants, animals, and factions of all types, there is no shortage of what's needed to set out and make your own dynamic history. And whether you develop a famous global cuisine, build the biggest empire, die in a massive war, or rise to unite differing peoples, you'll soon learn first hand it all comes down to what you decide to do with Sticks and Stones.